

ROHITHA EDARA

✉ rohitha.edara@outlook.com ☎ (814)-769-0198  [rohitha-edara](https://www.linkedin.com/in/rohitha-edara)  [rohitha-edara.github.io](https://github.com/rohitha-edara)

EDUCATION

Pennsylvania State University (PSU) <i>Ph.D. in Education Policy and Leadership</i>	<i>Aug 2019 – Aug 2025</i>
Michigan State University (MSU) <i>Master of Public Policy</i> <i>Master of Science in Community Sustainability</i>	<i>Aug 2015 – May 2019</i>
Osmania University <i>Bachelor of Arts in Humanities and Social Sciences (Political Science)</i>	<i>Aug 2011 – May 2014</i>

SKILLS

Data Management & Analysis:	Stata, R (including spatial data analysis, rvest, and R Markdown), Python (only data management using Pandas), SPSS
Data Visualization:	Microsoft Excel, Stata, R, Tableau
Quantitative Methods:	Regression analysis, Panel data methods, Causal econometric methods (especially difference-in-differences (DiD)), Spatial data analysis (using R), survey data analysis
Survey Design:	Qualtrics
AI Tools:	Claude Cowork, Claude Code
Media and Communication:	Adobe InDesign, Adobe Illustrator, Overleaf (LaTeX)
Languages:	English, French (Intermediate), Hindi, Telugu
Other:	Familiarity with Git/GitHub and SQL/Relational database management

EXPERIENCE

Research Experience:

- | | |
|---|----------------------------|
| Graduate Researcher, Dr. Erica Frankenberg, PSU | <i>Aug 2023 – Aug 2025</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Conducted quantitative data analysis to measure racial/ethnic segregation in Early Care and Education (ECE) classrooms using nationally-representative survey data• Investigated center- and community-level mechanisms driving racial/ethnic inequalities in wages and health insurance benefits of ECE teachers. | |
| Graduate Researcher, Dr. Maithreyi Gopalan, PSU | <i>Aug 2019 – May 2023</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Conducted systematic review of the effects of various health policies and programs on children's and adolescents' educational outcomes in the U.S.• Compiled and cleaned data from various sources including the Common Core of Data (CCD), Private School Universe Survey (PSS), and the Civil Rights Data Collection (CRDC) survey | |
| Research Intern, Ingham County Prosecuting Attorney's Office | <i>Jan 2019 – May 2019</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Conducted racial equity analysis by analyzing quantitative data to identify patterns of racial discrimination in levied charges, plea offers, and court sentences | |

Graduate Researcher, Community Evaluation and Research Collaborative, MSU Aug 2017 – May 2019

- Evaluated the local (Lansing) operations of a national, community-based program by the W.K. Kellogg Foundation to address historic and contemporary effects of racism, and advance racial equity
- Acted as the lead facilitator for focus groups, designed and administered in-person and online surveys (using Qualtrics), and analyzed qualitative and quantitative data (using SPSS)

Teaching Experience:

Graduate Teaching Assistant, EDTHP 115: Education in American Society, PSU Jan 2024 – May 2024

- Led discussion groups and graded assignments in introductory policy course for undergraduate students preparing for teaching careers, with Dr. Maryellen Schaub

Graduate Learning Assistant, PPL 806: Policy Evaluation, MSU

Jan 2019 – May 2019

- Advised graduate students on program evaluation proposals prior to submission, with Dr. Valentina Bali

Teaching Volunteer and Mentor, Make A Difference (Non-profit)

Aug 2013 – June 2014

- Taught Cambridge English language curriculum to a small group of 4th and 5th grade children living in alternative care facilities
- Mentored other teaching volunteers on curriculum planning and student management; conducted de-briefs to resolve concerns and facilitate discussion on pedagogical improvement

Other Professional Experience:

Graduate Program Assistant, School of Public Policy, PSU

Aug 2024 – Aug 2025

- Facilitated the year-long self-study process of the Master of Public Policy (MPP) program's accreditation with the Network of Schools of Public Policy, Affairs, and Administration (NASPAA)
- Collected, analyzed, and reported data on student achievement and career progress as well as metrics related to MPP program's implementation and evaluation procedures

Graduate Assistant, Writing Center, MSU

Aug 2016 – Aug 2017

- Coordinated operations at one undergraduate neighborhood; mentored undergraduate, graduate, and doctoral students from various disciplines in refining writing projects
- Conducted research on promoting inclusion and diversity among the writing center clientele; collaborated in designing surveys and analyzing results

Education Support Fellow and Trainer, Make A Difference

Aug 2014 – June 2015

- Led city operations of a pilot project to deliver education support to over 300 children in 7 shelter homes
- Recruited, trained, and managed around 250 volunteers to deliver Math, Science, and English education
- Collaborated with teams in 23 cities to co-design and implement the pilot project
- Led the city in conducting the highest number of classes and improving student scores

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles:

Gopalan, M., Edara, R. (2023). Health Policies as Education Policies? A Review of Causal Evidence and Mechanisms. *AERA Open*, 9, 23328584231177616.

Edara, R. (2025). Extent, patterns, and geographic scale of caste-based segregation in Indian schools. *International Journal of Educational Development*, 117, 103347. 10.1016/j.ijedudev.2025.103347.

Policy Reports:

Hollett, K. B., Frankenberg, E., & **Edara, R.** (2025). *Variation by Race in ECE Educators' Beliefs and Approaches to Caregiving* (Research on Disparities in Early Childhood Education). Center for Education and Civil Rights.

Edara, R., Hollett, K.B., Frankenberg, E. (2025). *Racial/Ethnic Composition and Segregation in ECE* (Research on Disparities in Early Childhood Education). Center for Education and Civil Rights.

Edara, R., Hollett, K.B., Frankenberg, E. (2025). *Racial/Ethnic Inequalities in the Teaching Contexts of ECE Workforce* (Research on Disparities in Early Childhood Education). Center for Education and Civil Rights.

COMPETITIVE AWARDS

Participant, Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS) - Howard/Mathematica	2023
Semi-finalist (acted as education expert for ClassCollab project), NittanyAI Challenge, PSU	2023
Scholarship Recipient, MSU Master of Public Policy Program	2017 – 2018